

# GitLab

GitLab: concept, Quality Engineering use cases, first steps and official reference.

## What is it?

GitLab is part of the modern software engineering and quality ecosystem. This guide explains its role, where it fits in the delivery flow, and how QA professionals can use it with the right context.

## Official site and documentation

Use the official GitLab source as the primary reference: <https://about.gitlab.com/>. Official documentation should be the first source for installation, supported versions, syntax changes and new features.

## Why should QA know it?

Understanding GitLab helps QA collaborate with development, DevOps, data and product teams. The goal is not to memorize commands, but to understand how the tool affects testability, automation, evidence, diagnostics and delivery quality.

## Getting started

Start with the official documentation, verify prerequisites and install only from the official source. In corporate environments, confirm internal policies, supported versions, permissions and environment variables before configuring GitLab.

## Practical QA use

Use GitLab in a small reproducible exercise. Record the goal, configuration, expected result, evidence and issues. Then connect the learning to a real testing, automation, integration, data or continuous-delivery scenario.

## Good practices

Prefer official documentation, never expose credentials, version configuration when appropriate, keep dependencies current and document important decisions. A tool without context does not replace a quality strategy.

## When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

## How to start safely

Start from the official GitLab site and documentation. Confirm prerequisites, supported versions, operating system and required permissions. Learn in a controlled environment before using it in a critical workflow.

## First QA-oriented use

Pick one small, verifiable task in GitLab, configure only what is necessary, run a simple example and confirm the outcome. Repeat with different data or conditions before adding abstractions.

## Using it in a real project

Define where GitLab fits, who owns configuration, how credentials and data are handled and how results are shared. Integrate it into the team workflow instead of creating an isolated activity.

## Common issues and troubleshooting

When GitLab fails, verify versions, dependencies, permissions, connectivity, data and environment before assuming a product defect. Preserve the original error and reduce the issue to the smallest reproducible case.